



Figure 3: Inspecting Chrome documents

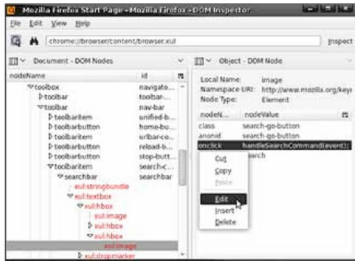


Figure 5: Inspecting a Web page

The following are a few common APIs in XML and Web page scripting that show the use of DOM:

- `document.getElementById (id)`
- `element.getElementsByTagName (name)`
- `document.createElement (name)`
- `parentNode.appendChild (node)`
- `element.innerHTML`
- `element.style.left`
- `element.setAttribute`
- `element.getAttribute`
- `element.addEventListener`
- `window.content`
- `window.onload`
- `window.dump`
- `window.scrollTo`

## Testing the DOM API

Here, you will be provided samples for every interface that you can use in Web development. In some cases, the samples are complete HTML pages, with the DOM access in a `<script>` element, the interface (e.g., buttons) necessary to fire up the script in a form, and the HTML elements upon which the DOM operates listed as well. When this is the case, you can cut and paste the example into a new HTML document, save it, and run the example from the browser.

There are some cases, however, when the examples are more concise. To run examples that only demonstrate the basic relationship of the interface to the HTML elements, you may want to set up a test page in which interfaces can be



Figure 4: Inspecting arbitrary URLs

easily accessed from scripts.

## An introduction to the DOM inspector

The DOM inspector is a Mozilla extension that you can access from the **Tools -> Web Development** menu in SeaMonkey, or by selecting the DOM inspector menu item from the Tools menu in Firefox and Thunderbird or by using `Ctrl/Cmd+Shift+I` in either application. The DOM inspector is a "standalone" extension; it supports all toolkit applications, and it's possible to embed it in your own *XULRunner* app. The DOM inspector can serve as a sanity check to verify the state of the DOM, or it can be used to manipulate the DOM manually, if desired.

When you first start the DOM inspector, you are presented with a two-pane application window that looks a little like the main Mozilla browser. Like the browser, the DOM inspector includes an address bar and some of the same menus. In SeaMonkey, additional global menus are available.

## Using the DOM inspector

Once you've opened the document for the page you are interested in Chrome, you'll see that it loads the DOM nodes viewer in the document pane and the DOM node viewer in the object pane. In the DOM nodes viewer, there should be a structured, hierarchical view of the DOM.

By clicking around in the document pane, you'll see that the viewers are linked; whenever you select a new node from the DOM nodes viewer, the DOM node viewer is automatically updated to reflect the information for that node. Linked viewers are the first major aspect to understand when learning how to use the DOM inspector.

## Inspecting a document

When the DOM inspector opens, it may or may not load an associated document, depending on the host application. If it doesn't automatically load a document or loads a document other than the one you'd like to inspect, you can select the desired document in a few different ways.